

TWIST THE TANGO

written by
Cairns Nolan

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Blue Sheep Films
Toronto, ON
sacha@bluesheepfilms.com

EXT. TORONTO STREETS - 5:00PM

The day is done. Leather strapped business men and women pour from their aluminum and concrete buildings into the busy downtown beat of Toronto.

The golden hour traces the power lines of the street cars. Lights change, crowds halt and resume again. Patios are being setup on the sidewalks.

It's Friday, and all is renewed.

INT. VINCENTS OFFICE - 5:30PM

Inside, people are packing up.

Some stop to chat, others are seen putting on headphones out the door.

Only VINCENT(25) remains seated, staring at his phone which sits next to his keyboard. He looks tired, as though he had

been in that chair for a month. His hair still resembles the shape it was styled into that morning, but with less integrity. His eyes are as dark as his shirt, and as red as his tie.

A couple men walk by his desk and wish him a pleasant evening. He glances up at them with a polite nod before returning his gaze to his phone.

Moments pass. The phone remains dark.

In defeat, Vincent rises from his desk and stretches. He puts his laptop into its carrier and retrieves the phone, just as it lights up with the name:

"UNKNOWN"

dHe answers, hastily.

EXT. TORONTO STREETS - 5:45PM

Closer to the heart of the city, the crowd is dressed in the blue and white of the local baseball team. Among them is COREY (26), wearing a blue jersey with the matching hat and baggy jeans. His face is half covered in blue paint, which visibility itches.

He leans against a pole outside the stadium, a sea of baseball fans surge on either side of him.

He looks down, checks his phone, fidgets with the device before resigning it to his pocket. He notices someone smoking near him, and instinctively pats his breast pockets.

He pulls out a pack of cigarettes, gives them the obligatory smack, before pulling out a stick and raising it to his lips.

As he raises his head to light, his eyes meet her. SHORTY #1 is all but matching Corey, her white baseball jersey completely covers the shorts she has underneath. She walks over, phone in hand, smiling smugly with pink lips.

Corey resigns the cigarette to the pack.

COREY

Oh, hi.

SHORTY #1

(observing him)

So, this is Corey.

COREY

Home grown, one and only.

SHORTY #1

Your profile says 6'1 ...

COREY

I am 6'1.

SHORTY #1

I'm sure.

COREY

So am I, you're just super tall.

SHORTY #1

I'm 5'8.

COREY

Yeah maybe before the recession...

He puts his arm around her, turning them into the direction of the stadium.

COREY (CONT'D)

... But in this economy?

The two walk off towards the stadium, slipping through the crowd. They weave through families and other couples, searching for their entrance into the stadium.

COREY
I think we're next but fuck it,
lines small here.

He moves forward towards the lines but Shorty stops him.

SHORTY #1
Are you tryna smoke?

Her sentence trails as she slides a joint out of her tiny bag.

COREY
Oh you bet.

SHORTY #1
Okay but you hit first, or you'll
be covered in my lip gloss.

COREY
(sarcastic)
How horrible.

The two step from the direction of the crowd and into a park.

INT. VINCENT'S OFFICE - 6PM

Nervous eyes are lit by a computer screen. They dart furiously back and forth.

The Vincent is clicking through multiple documents on his screen. Some legal contracts, media bookings and data reports.

He sits back and puts his hands behind his head. He rubs his face, and breathes steadily. He exhales, and recomposes.

His head raises.

VINCENT
Reba!

No response.

VINCENT (CONT'D)
... Reba?

Vincent gets out of his chair and pokes his head out of his small office. The place is abandoned, no computers alight, all chairs tucked in.

He scratches his head, sighs, confirms his suspicions with his watch, and retreats back into his dimly lit space.

He sits himself down, pops in his cord headphones and gets back to work.

In front of him are multiple screens that Vincent uses to cycle in different windows of data, while typing the findings furiously into an email.

His head nods along to his music.

INT. STADIUM - 7PM

Corey is at the urinal, relieving himself.

He notices the man next to him is eating a hotdog, with both hands.

Corey looks at him up and down, impressed by the control.

The man takes notice to Corey. They make eye contact and nod. Corey turns back to the wall laughing.

He checks his phone. No notifications.

INT. VINCENT'S OFFICE - 7PM

Vincent now stands away from his computer, enjoying a Diet Pepsi. He stares at the little trinkets in his office, fidgeting with each one as his attention falls to it.

He pulls his phone out. Seeing that there's no notifications, he sets it down on his desk before turning out the window.

The sun flirts with the horizon on the lake. Gold washes the streets clean.

He retires back to his chair and settles into his routine when his phone goes off. Unflinching, he remains dutifully

focused on his task.

Then it rings again, and again.

Seeing that there seems to be no end to the string of texts, he picks up his phone and stares at them indifferently.

His face remains stone as the text populate his phone. One after another his face begins to sour. He scrolls back and forth before slowly standing.

Vincent picked up the call after one ring, with the strength of a man trying to lift a car.

VINCENT

Hey - yeah I saw Eric's texts in the chat. It's speculators though, I don't know why he's up in arms over shit we already knew about ...

Vincent paces in front of his desk listening to the phone. He opens a new tab on google and brings up an article.

VINCENT (CONT'D)

... the Star has reported nothing since Wednesday's update. Plus, any of SayFlair's client list wouldn't be released until Monday, even if the takeover happened today.

Vincent takes the phone off his ear and lends it to speaker, while he begins to type up a message to Corey.

TEXT - News on Sayflair?

MAN ON PHONE

... fuck whatever the star is telling you. They're owned by a PMG shell company, they won't release shit. This is coming from the whores mouth.

VINCENT

Horses Mouth.

MAN ON PHONE

Same thing.

VINCENT

How? Where did Eric hear that this is signed and sealed?

MAN ON PHONE

His aunt, dude. His fucking aunt is an exec at Sayflair. Apparently she just texted his Dad that it went through.

VINCENT

What? Why? She gets laid off and texts her brother?

MAN ON PHONE

No idea. But he's adamant.

VINCENT

Yeah clearly, he hasn't stopped texting since. I just don't trust it.

MAN ON PHONE
Either way, this won't be
actionable till Monday.

Vincent goes quiet, and begins to ponder. He traces his jaw
with his fingers while unfocusing his eyes.

... Vin? MAN ON PHONE (CONT'D)

VINCENT
Yeah, here.

MAN ON PHONE
... what are you thinking.

VINCENT
Nothing, nothing till Monday ...

MAN ON PHONE
Vin.

VINCENT
I'm gonna call Paul.

MAN ON PHONE
From Canacor?

VINCENT
Yeah, doesn't hurt to confirm this
right?

MAN ON PHONE
Would he know?

VINCENT
Well the news seems to travel, he
might.

MAN ON PHONE
If he does tell me.

VINCENT
Oh yeah, why's that?

MAN ON PHONE
Hey who was the guy who told you to
stay late in the office tonight in
preparation for this shit.

VINCENT
Yeah sure you did pal, not like
these 100 messages wouldn't tip me
off.

MAN ON PHONE

Don't be a cunt. We don't even have competing clients dude.

VINCENT

Hm. Fine, but for the record - this is what a favour looks like.

MAN ON PHONE

Yeah, yeah.

VINCENT

Kisses.

MAN ON PHONE

Fuck off.

The call ends, and Vincent is left burning in his small office.

INT. BASEBALL GAME - 7:30PM

Corey makes his way down the concrete steps with a slow wide gate. He stops at his row and motions to the family that they'll need to get up to let him pass.

After the obligatory chain of Sorry's, Corey makes his way to his seat, where Shorty sits expressionless on her phone.

COREY

(handing her a beer)

They didn't have ... the thing you
(MORE)

COREY (CONT'D)

wanted.

SHORTY #1

(perplexed)

They didn't have Vodka Tonic?

COREY

(sipping his beer)

Nope.

Shorty gives him a suspicious look before raising her pint delicately to her lips, as not to disturb her gloss. She winces after a sip but nods and takes another.

SHORTY #1

This is actually okay, wow, I usually really don't like beer.

COREY
Really? Could have sworn you were
big into the pints.

They both make a sarcastic smile at each other and have
another sip.

The game continues to rage on.

INT. VINCENTS OFFICE - 7:45PM

Vincent is waiting in the outer hall for the elevator. He
anxiously massages the tail of his neck tie as he waits.

The elevator arrives and Vincent steps in. He picks the 11th
floor and the carriage begins to descend.

He finds himself in an identical hallway, flanked by locked
doors on either sides leading to different businesses.

His phone acts as his alibi, as he pretends to scroll
through it waiting, hoping for someone to open the door.

An absent minded assistant emerges from behind the door
rushing towards the elevator, Vincent slips in.

He weaves past a kitchen into a narrow hall. Most of the
rooms are dark, surrounded by empty desks. He moves past
them with purpose, approaching the final board room, with
its lights on.

He pauses, takes a breath and enters.

VINCENT
(newly confident, almost
mocking.)
Gentlemen - I have heard some
disturbing news on the 15th floor.

Three men sit around a massive wooden table - laptops,
dossiers, coffee cups scatter across it.

Another man stands at the window with hands on his hips, he
turns and meets Vincent with a defeated glare.

MAN AT WINDOW
Jesus Christ - what's it been ...

He turns to the rest of the men, checking his watch.

MAN AT WINDOW (CONT'D)
Fifteen minutes.

VINCENT
News travels fast, Gerald.

GERALD (35), wears a hoodie and jeans that are a bit too tight for a man of his age. He shifts back towards his lackeys.

GERALD
How did you even get in here?

Vincent walks over to the table and begins casing the work spread out across it. He flips a dossier over.

VINCENT
I got in here because I wanted to get in here. I thought we could have a friendly conversation.

GERALD
About?

VINCENT
The future of this brand.

Gerald laughs and begins to rub his eyes. He pulls a seat out and motions Vincent to follow in his suit.

GERALD
(sarcastically)
All I have today are friendly conversations.

VINCENT
So I have heard. I just had a few questions before we move forward.

GERALD
Moving forward isn't something we're capable of at the moment. I'm sure you've heard that Sayflair has been sold.

VINCENT
Why do you think I'm here Gerald.

GERALD
Oh I know why you're here. I didn't think you'd be able to smell the blood that many floors up.

Vincent gives him an obligatory smile. He rubs his hands that are sweating against his thigh.

GERALD (CONT'D)

No matter what you or Desmond have
to

say, we will be weighing our options over the next few
weeks. We would be happy to take a call with your firm.

VINCENT

Desmond didn't send me.

Gerald leans forward, grinning.

GERALD

So what is this then?

VINCENT

I want to represent you. You would
be my first and only account.

GERALD

You want to be an AM that bad, huh?

VINCENT

What I want is to represent you.
Our partnership with Sayflair saw
this company stewarded in the same
stream as 20 other companies just
like it. Desmond managed the best
he could but we both know that you
got side skirted - no new
innovative additions, no marketing
XM. Sayflair relegated this
(MORE)

VINCENT (CONT'D)

company into nothing more than a
data centre.

GERALD

Your man Desmond had a big hand in
that.

VINCENT

I know. Which is why I am here. I
heard the rumours earlier this week
that Sayflair may be liquidating.

The two men face off. Vincent glances around the room and
notices the three, tired assistants are now listening
attentively. The A.C. softly pushes around looseleaf on the
table.

VINCENT (CONT'D)

Let me manage you. I'll be your
steward into your next chapter.

GERALD

Our steward eh? A twenty something

year old who's eager to get his dick wet isn't exactly going to go over well with our senior management. But I appreciate your words, and your drive Vincent. And listen I'm saying this nicely because I know your Mother, but being in this office is a violation of about fifteen corporate laws and two real laws. So we appreciate your time, and what you had to say - but leave or we'll call security, alright.

Vincent's face goes red. He knows he is losing his chance.

GERALD (CONT'D)

... and I promise I won't tell
Desmond about this little stunt of
yours. You got balls, buddy, but
this isn't a Martin Scorsese film.

VINCENT

(smiling politely)

I had to try, right?

Vincent stands to leave, thumbing his tie again. Before he turns to the door, he address the room, not just Gerald.

VINCENT (CONT'D)

You do know what's going to happen though. You'll be picked up again, by my agency or another and handed to some prick who's already got a handful of clients just like you. Maybe they butter you up to get you to sign, promise funding on some old desire of yours to restart an old project, or give you more brand exposure. But that will be it, two months in you'll be back to being a data centre, having to fire the creative team you put in play just months earlier. But I get it, stick to what you know right, you haven't turned out a new project since what? I was probably in the seventh grade so excuse me for not knowing.

The men in the room are visibly agitated with Vincent's speech.

VINCENT (CONT'D)

... or you could grow some balls like me, buddy. You give me a chance to represent you and I'll have people my age and younger flocking back to this brand as though you had never been relegated. I'll give you another opportunity to actually make something. You won't be a stepping stone to another flagship, your company will no longer host traffic for your competitors.

Moving towards the door, Vincent makes his final remark.

VINCENT (CONT'D)

But what do I care. I know I'm going back up there with a client - whether it's you or one of the other Sayflair IPs that got released today. I'm going up, guarenteed. You? Not so much.

Gerald is smiling now. He's leaning back, bouncing against the chair. He turns to the other men in the room and shakes his head.

GERALD

You ... you have got to work on your next pitch. Because on Monday when I

(MORE)

GERALD (CONT'D)

speak with my boss on leads for who's going to represent us - he's going to want to hear it from you directly.

Vincent feels like flying, but musters everything in him to keep his feet on the ground and his frown glued to his face.

VINCENT

It worked for you, it will work for them.

GERALD

You may be right.

VINCENT

Tell you what, Monday evening let me take you out to Tintin - it's a new steakhouse off of King. We can get into it then.

GERALD

Hope you know what you're doing kid.

VINCENT
I'm exactly where I want to be,
doing what I want to do. Let's say
7pm, I'll be there to receive you.

GERALD
(nodding)
7pm it is, good luck.

VINCENT
Cheers.

Vincent exits the office.